

Daily Bible Note

Date: June 7, 2026

I. Today's Reading

NKJV: 1 Corinthians 13:1-7

1 Though I speak with the tongues of men and of angels, but have not love, I have become sounding brass or a clanging cymbal.

2 And though I have the gift of prophecy, and understand all mysteries and all knowledge, and though I have all faith, so that I could remove mountains, but have not love, I am nothing.

3 And though I bestow all my goods to feed the poor, and though I give my body to be burned, but have not love, it profits me nothing.

4 Love suffers long and is kind; love does not envy; love does not parade itself, is not puffed up;

5 does not behave rudely, does not seek its own, is not provoked, thinks no evil;

6 does not rejoice in iniquity, but rejoices in the truth;

7 bears all things, believes all things, hopes all things, endures all things.

II. Key Summary

- Paul lists speaking in tongues, prophetic gifts, mountain-moving faith, giving away all possessions, and even dying as a martyr — then states that without love, none of it benefits the person doing it.

- Verses 4–6 alternate between what love is (patient, kind, rejoicing in truth) and what love is not (envious, boastful, self-seeking, easily provoked, keeping a record of wrongs).

- Verse 7 closes with four "all things" — bears, believes, hopes, endures — showing love has no exceptions and sets no conditions.

III. Passage Analysis

Great Deeds Without Love Are Just Empty Noise

"Without love, whatever I speak, whatever I have, whatever I know, whatever I do, whatever I suffer, is nothing." [1]

In verses 1–3, Paul lines up one impressive act after another — speaking angelic languages, faith that moves mountains, even dying for the faith — and then says: without love, none of it profits you. This isn't a put-down of those acts themselves. The point is that love is what makes any action meaningful. If the motive isn't genuinely about the other person, even the biggest gesture is really just keeping score for yourself.

Love Is a List of Actions, Not a Feeling

"Paul is not writing about how love feels, he is writing about how it can be seen in action. True love is always demonstrated by action." [2]

Every description in verses 4–7 is observable behavior — patience, kindness, not keeping records of wrongs, bearing everything. These aren't emotional states; they're choices. That means love is something you can practice. You don't have to wait until it "feels right" to start.

IV. Reflection Question

Think of a time you got into a misunderstanding with a friend or a family member — and even though you were still upset inside, you chose to keep showing up for them. What made you do it?

Paul says love has little to do with how you feel and a lot to do with choosing to put the other person first. Looking back at that moment — do you think you were loving them, or just trying to keep things from getting more awkward?

References

[1] BibleHub.com, Benson Commentary,
https://www.biblehub.com/commentaries/1_corinthians/13-1.htm

[2] Enduring Word, David Guzik,
<https://enduringword.com/bible-commentary/1-corinthians-13/>